

Soldering and Desoldering Stations

Emerging Opportunities

Today, soldering and desoldering applications range from repair of consumer electronics devices such as mobile phones, laptop PCBs and gaming stations to production, rework and hand-soldering of odd-form assemblies. Solar panel manufacture is an area which has seen significant growth

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The demand for soldering and desoldering stations in India is growing steadily due to increased manufacturing activity in the electronics industry. Apart from indigenous manufacturers, many foreign companies have set up shops in India.

Though a large number of domestically produced soldering products are available, majority of the demand for soldering and desoldering stations is being met by imports. The main reason for imports is the state-of-the-art technology offered by foreign manufacturers.

There are products available from Germany, Japan, Korea and China.

Certain companies look for comparatively cheap products. Their demand is easily met by Chinese products which cost lower than their Indian counterparts. Also, there are companies which look for best-quality products irrespective of the high cost of these products. Here also the domestic products fail as they cannot match up the quality of European and American products.

Over the years, these products have evolved in technology as well as hardware to meet the growing demands of the consumers. With the trend towards surface-mount technology (SMT) and compliance to ROHS (Restriction on Hazardous Substances) directive, manufacturers are demanding technologically advanced soldering systems. SmartHeat Conduction products offered by OK International are claimed to satisfy these needs with their inherent capability to solder faster at safer temperatures.

Major application areas

Soldering and desoldering stations

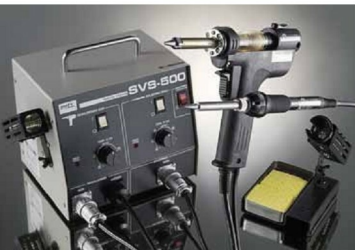
are used in small manufacturing lines as well as electronics repair centres. Major application areas are production centres and service centres in the electronics and telecom industry, R&D labs and hardware centres.

"Production and repairing centres in electronics and telecom industries are the areas where demand for soldering and desoldering stations is the largest," informs Sumeet Chadda, director, Blue Sky Systems.

Manish Kwatra, CEO, Metro Electronic, divides the users into two broad categories:

1. Small or medium repair workshops or even hobbyists: Here the types of instruments being used range from basic soldering irons to small soldering stations.
2. Small-/large-scale manufacturing units: Here the instruments range from soldering stations to hot-air stations to wave-soldering machines.

"Soldering and desoldering applications range from repair of consumer electronics devices such as mobile phones, laptop PCBs and gaming stations to production, rework and hand-soldering of odd-form assemblies. Solar panel manufacture is an area which has seen significant growth in recent years," shares Nathalie Morin, marketing communications manager, OK International.



Goot SVS-500 soldering-desoldering station